AGENCY OPERATIONS VAULT • V4.2

COMPLETE FREELANCE & AGENCY CLIENT ONBOARDING, PROPOSAL & CONTRACT SOP KIT

Turnkey Operations Manual: High-Ticket Discovery Scripts, Ironclad Scope-of-Work Templates, Milestone Payment Clauses, Anti-Scope-Creep Enforcement

EXECUTIVE SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE & INCLUDED ASSETS

- **Discovery & Sales Architecture:** SPIN/MEDDIC Qualification Matrix & 45-Minute Diagnostic Script
- **Proposal & Pricing Engineering:** 3-Tier Value Anchoring & ROI Business Case Calculator
- **Legal & Payment Security:** Milestone Billing Clauses, Kill-Fees, Late-Payment & IP Transfer Rules
- **Zero-Creep Delivery & Kickoff:** 72-Hour Onboarding Workflow, Change-Order Triggers & Async Cadence
- **Offboarding & LTV Expansion:** Handover Protocol, Case Study Extraction & Retainer Upsell Scripts

EDITION & LICENSING SPECIFICATION

Commercial Agency License • Includes 21 Production-Ready SOP Modules, Legal Clause Frameworks, Kickoff Checklists & Referral Engines.

SOP-01 • OPERATIONS BLUEPRINT

Master Agency Client Lifecycle & SOP Architecture

End-to-end operational flow from inbound lead capture to recurring retainer expansion

High-margin agencies do not fail from lack of creative skill; they fail from operational friction, unbilled scope creep, and ambiguous client expectations. This manual installs a repeatable 6-stage lifecycle across every client account.

Stage	Operational Objective	Primary Asset / Artifact	SLA Target
01. Triage	Filter out low-budget/high-friction leads	Inbound Qualification Form	< 4 Hours
02. Discovery	Quantify cost of inaction & define KPIs	45-Min Diagnostic Call Script	24-48 Hours
03. Proposal	Anchor 3-tier ROI options & close deal	3-Option SOW & ROI Deck	< 48 Hours
04. Contract	Lock payment milestones & IP protection	Master Services Agreement	Same Day
05. Onboarding	Provision portal, assets & kickoff call	72-Hour Welcome Sequence	< 72 Hours
06. Offboarding	Capture testimonial & pitch retainer	Handover Packet & Upsell Pitch	Final Week

Core Agency Profit Protection Rules (Non-Negotiable Standards)

- [ ] **Rule #1 — No Work Before Cleared Deposit:** Project timelines start on the date the initial 50% milestone invoice clears in the bank.
- [ ] **Rule #2 — Single Point of Contact (SPOC):** Client must designate one decision-maker to consolidate feedback and sign off deliverables.
- [ ] **Rule #3 — Written Change Orders Only:** Any request outside the signed SOW triggers an automated Change Order quotation.
- [ ] **Rule #4 — Asynchronous Default:** Ad-hoc calls are replaced by Loom updates and structured weekly status digests.

IMPLEMENTATION STANDARD

Clone these checklists into Notion, ClickUp, or Linear as a master template. Never onboard a client manually.

SOP-02 • LEAD QUALIFICATION

Pre-Discovery Lead Qualification & Red-Flag Matrix

Score inbound prospects before granting calendar access to protect executive selling time

Every unqualified discovery call costs an agency 90 minutes of deep-work capacity. Deploy this mandatory intake questionnaire on your booking page (Cal.com / Calendly / SavvyCal) and score leads before confirming the meeting.

Qualification Dimension	Green Flag (+25 Pts)	Yellow Flag (+10 Pts)	Red Flag (Auto-Decline)
Budget Floor	Confirmed > $5,000 budget	$2,500–$5,000 flexible	"Cheapest quote wins"
Decision Authority	Founder / VP with sign-off	Manager reporting to C-suite	Committee / No authority
Timeline Urgency	Clear 14–30 day launch goal	Exploring Q2/Q3 options	"Wanted it done yesterday"
Past Agency Experience	Values strategic partners	First time hiring agency	Fired 3 agencies in 6 mos
Problem Clarity	Specific revenue/ops bottleneck	General growth desire	Vague / "I'll know when I see it"

Polite Decline & Referral Email Script (For Sub-Minimum Budget Leads)

"Subject: Quick update regarding your [Project Name] inquiry"

"Hi [First Name], thank you for sharing the details of [Company]'s upcoming initiative."

"Based on the scope and target investment range shared on your intake form, our core engagement minimum ($[X,XXX]) wouldn't be the most capital-efficient fit for your current stage."
"Instead of wasting your time on a call, I've attached our self-serve [Playbook/Resource] and copied two vetted independent specialists who excel in the $[X,XXX] range. Wishing you a massive launch!"

TRIAGE AUTOMATION TIP

Configure conditional routing in Typeform/Tally: prospects selecting budgets below your floor are redirected to a digital product or waitlist page instead of your live calendar.

SOP-03 • DIAGNOSTIC SALES

The 45-Minute High-Ticket Discovery Call Script (Opening & Diagnosis)

Frame authority in the first 3 minutes and uncover high-value business pain without pitching prematurely

Treat the discovery call like a surgeon conducting a diagnostic MRI. Do not prescribe solutions in the first 25 minutes. Follow this exact time-boxed script to establish authority and extract quantifiable ROI metrics.

Phase 1 & 2 Verbatim Script (Minutes 00:00 to 25:00)

01. FRAME CONTROL (Min 0–3): "Thanks for joining, [Name]. To make these 45 minutes maximally valuable, I'd love to understand where [Company] is today, where you want to be in 90 days, and the exact bottlenecks standing in the way. If there's an obvious fit, I'll walk through how our system works. Sound fair?"
02. CURRENT STATE (Min 3–10): "Walk me through how [process/acquisition/product] is currently handled. What prompted you to prioritize fixing this right now rather than six months ago?"
03. QUANTIFYING PAIN (Min 10–18): "When this bottleneck happens, what does it cost you per month in lost revenue, delayed launches, or team payroll hours?"
04. FAILED ATTEMPTS (Min 18–25): "What have you already tried internally or with previous vendors to solve this, and why didn't it stick?"

Mandatory Metrics to Extract Before Pitching

- [ ] **Baseline Metric:** Current conversion rate, monthly revenue, lead volume, or cycle time.
- [ ] **Target 90-Day Metric:** Exact numeric outcome that defines a wildly successful engagement.
- [ ] **Cost of Inaction (COI):** Monthly financial bleed if the client waits another 6 months to solve the problem.
- [ ] **Stakeholder Map:** Who else needs to review the proposal (CFO, Co-founder, Legal) before signing?

SOP-04 • PITCH & OBJECTION HANDLING

Discovery Call Script: Solution Bridge, Price Anchoring & Objections

Transition smoothly from diagnosis to your 3-pillar framework and neutralize stall tactics live

Once the prospect verbalizes their monthly Cost of Inaction, present your methodology in 3 pillars (never features or hours). Anchor your fee against their annual upside and secure a firm proposal review commitment.

Common Prospect Objection	Diagnostic Reframe Question (Say This Verbatim)
"Can you just send a price over email?"	"Happy to—so I don't send a $30k enterprise build when you need a $8k sprint, which tier of speed are we optimizing for?"
"That's higher than other quotes."	"Totally fair. Are those quotes guaranteeing [Specific KPI Outcome] or just billing hours for raw deliverables?"
"We need to think about it."	"Of course. Usually that means either the ROI timeline feels unclear or the scope feels risky—which one should we unpack?"
"Can we start next quarter?"	"We can, though earlier you mentioned this bottleneck costs ~$[X]/mo—is waiting 90 days worth losing $[3X]?"

Phase 3 & 4 Verbatim Script (Minutes 25:00 to 45:00)

05. THE 3-PILLAR BRIDGE (Min 25–33): "Based on what you shared—specifically [Pain A] costing ~$[X]/mo—we solve this in three phases: Phase 1 is [Audit/Architecture], Phase 2 is [Core Build/Execution], and Phase 3 is [Optimization & Handover].

06. PRICE ANCHOR (Min 33–38): "Clients who want to capture that $[Annual Upside] outcome typically invest between $[Tier 1] and $[Tier 3] depending on speed and hands-on support. How does that align with what you allocated?

07. LOCKING NEXT STEP (Min 38–45): "I will build a tailored 3-option Scope of Work by tomorrow at 2 PM. Let's put a 15-minute slot on the calendar for Thursday to review the exact numbers together."

SOP-05 • VALUE-BASED PRICING

High-Converting 3-Tier Proposal & Pricing Matrix

Eliminate "yes or no" binary decisions by presenting Good / Better / Best ROI options

Single-price proposals force clients to compare you against external competitors. A 3-tier proposal shifts the buyer's brain from "Should we hire them?" to "Which tier of speed and certainty do we want?"

Proposal Component	Tier 1: Foundation (1.0x)	Tier 2: Growth Accelerator (1.6x)	Tier 3: Enterprise Turnkey (2.5x)
Strategic Positioning	Do-It-With-You Core Specs	Full Execution (Recommended)	Done-For-You + Speed + Advisory
Core Deliverables	Essential baseline scope only	Full scope + conversion optimization	Full scope + custom integrations
Delivery Speed	Standard 6-week timeline	Priority 4-week timeline	Dedicated 2-week sprint
Revision Rounds	1 consolidated round	2 consolidated rounds	3 rounds + 30-day post-launch
Communication	Async bi-weekly email digest	Weekly Loom + Slack channel	Dedicated Slack + Weekly Live Call
Target Fee Ratio	$5,000 Anchor Floor	$8,000 Sweet Spot (65% pick)	$12,500 Decoy / Whale Anchor

THE 5-PAGE PROPOSAL RULE

Page 1: Executive Summary & Cost of Inaction. Page 2: 90-Day Target Outcomes. Page 3: 3-Phase Roadmap & Timeline. Page 4: 3-Tier Investment Matrix. Page 5: Immediate Next Steps & Signature Block.

SOP-06 • IRONCLAD SOW

Ironclad Scope of Work (SOW) Specification Template

Define explicit deliverables, acceptance criteria, and explicit exclusions to eliminate ambiguity

Every dispute in agency history stems from vague nouns in the Scope of Work ("Website Redesign", "Marketing Strategy"). Replace vague nouns with countable, verifiable outputs and explicit exclusions.

Workstream / Phase	Exact Deliverable Specification	Explicitly Out of Scope (Exclusions)	Acceptance Criteria
Phase 1: Architecture	1x Figma Wireframe System (up to 8 unique views, desktop + mobile)	Custom 3D illustrations, copywriting exceeding 4,000	Written sign-off in Figma within 3
Phase 2: Production	Production build in Next.js/Webflow + CMS setup for 2 collections	Third-party ERP migration, legacy database scrubbing	Passes Lighthouse >90 & QA checklist
Phase 3: QA & Launch	Cross-browser testing (Chrome, Safari, iOS) + DNS cutover	Ongoing paid ad management or post-launch content entry	Live URL resolves with SSL active

Mandatory SOW Protection Clauses to Paste Into Every Schedule A

- [ ] **Consolidated Feedback Rule:** A "revision round" means a single batched document of edits submitted by the Client SPOC within 72 hours.
- [ ] **Deemed Approval Clause:** Deliverables not reviewed by Client within 5 business days of delivery are automatically deemed approved.
- [ ] **Client Dependency Buffer:** Every day Client delays providing required assets extends the final delivery deadline by 1.5 business days.
- [ ] **Asset Format Requirement:** All client-supplied copy, logos, and credentials must be uploaded to the Onboarding Portal prior to Kickoff.

SOP-07 • CASHFLOW PROTECTION

Milestone Payment Schedules & Financial Protection Clauses

Tie billing to calendar dates or phase starts—never to subjective "client satisfaction"

Never structure payments as "50% upfront, 50% upon completion." If a client delays final review for four months, your cashflow is held hostage. Use calendar-backed or phase-gate billing with automated pause rights.

Copy-Paste Legal Clauses: Payment Milestones, Late Fees & Pause Rights

CLAUSE 4.1 (HYBRID MILESTONE SCHEDULE): "Client shall pay 50% upon Agreement execution, 25% upon delivery of Phase 1 Architecture (or Day 15 from Effective Date, whichever occurs first), and 25% upon Phase 2 Staging Delivery (or Day 30 from Effective Date, whichever occurs first).

CLAUSE 4.2 (LATE PAYMENT & WORK SUSPENSION): "Invoices unpaid 5 business days past the due date accrue a 1.5% monthly administrative fee. At Day 7 past due, Agency automatically pauses all workstreams and revokes staging access. A $500 Restart Fee applies to resume work.

CLAUSE 4.3 (DORMANT PROJECT / RESTART FEE): "If Client becomes unresponsive for 14 consecutive business days, the project is placed in Archive Status. Reactivating an archived project requires a $750 Rescheduling Fee and re-queuing into Agency's next available sprint."

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY (IP) LEVERAGE CLAUSE

Include Clause 7.2: "All working files, source code, and deliverables remain the exclusive property of Agency until 100% of all principal invoices and Change Orders are paid in full."

SOP-08 • SCOPE DEFENSE

Anti-Scope-Creep Enforcement & Kill-Fee Contract Clauses

Turn "quick favors" into high-margin Change Orders without damaging client rapport

Scope creep rarely arrives as a demand; it arrives as a friendly Slack message: "Hey, while you're in there, could we also quickly add..." Train your team to respond with enthusiastic warmth paired with an immediate Change Order price.

Clause Name	Contractual Trigger	Financial & Operational Effect
Kill-Fee / Early Termination	Client cancels after kickoff without cause	Deposit is non-refundable + 50% of remaining contract value due immediately
Out-of-Scope Rate Card	Ad-hoc tasks approved via email/Slack	Billed at $195/hr in 2-hour minimum blocks on next invoice
Rush / Weekend Turnaround	Client requests delivery inside <48h window	+50% Urgency Multiplier applied to line-item cost
Third-Party License Pass-Through	Fonts, APIs, plugins, stock media	Billed directly to Client credit card on file

The "Yes, And Here Is How We Queue It" Slack/Email Response Script

"Hey [Name]! Love that idea—adding [Requested Feature] will definitely help boost [Goal]."

"To keep our current launch deadline on track for [Date], we have two easy options:"

"Option A: We swap out [Existing Unstarted Item of Equal Size] from Phase 2 and replace it with this at zero extra cost."

"Option B: I can spin up a quick 1-page Change Order for $[X,XXX] (adds 4 business days) and slot it right after launch. Which works best for you?"

SOP-09 • RAPID ACTIVATION

The 72-Hour Golden Window Onboarding Sequence

Eliminate buyer's remorse in the first 72 hours after payment with military-grade orchestration

The moment a client wires a $5,000–$25,000 deposit, buyer's remorse peaks. If they hear silence for two days, trust erodes. Execute this automated 72-hour sequence to make them feel they hired the most organized team on earth.

Timestamp	Owner	Action / Automation Trigger	Client-Facing Output
Hour 00:05	Automation	Stripe/Wire webhook fires Zapier/Make flow	Instant Receipt + Welcome Email #1
Hour 00:15	Automation	Clone Notion Client Portal & Google Drive folder	Shared Portal Link + Asset Upload Vault
Hour 02:00	Account Lead	Record 90-second personalized Loom video	Personal Welcome Video in Slack/ Email
Hour 24:00	Client SPOC	Complete Intake Questionnaire & credential handover	1Password / LastPass Vault shared
Hour 48:00	Project Mgr	Audit uploaded assets & confirm Kickoff Agenda	Pre-Kickoff Brief & Calendar Confirmation
Hour 72:00	Full Team	Conduct 45-Minute Executive Kickoff Call	Approved Roadmap & Sprint 1 Live

ZERO-TOUCH PROVISIONING STACK

Connect PandaDoc/DocuSign -> Stripe -> Make.com -> Notion API + Slack API. Signing the contract should automatically create the client folder, Slack channel, and kickoff invite in 12 seconds.

SOP-10 • CLIENT COMMUNICATIONS

Welcome Email Sequence & Pre-Kickoff Intake Questionnaire

Copy-paste welcome dispatch and structured asset collection form

Welcome Email #1 — Sent Immediately Upon Contract & Deposit Confirmation

"Subject: Welcome aboard, [Company] — Your Client Portal & Next Steps [Action Required]"

"Hi [First Name], thrilled to officially welcome [Company] to our roster! Your initial deposit is confirmed and our team is already provisioning your workspace."

"To ensure our Kickoff Call on [Date/Time] is 100% strategic, please complete these 3 quick items by [Day before Kickoff]:"

"1. Bookmark your Dedicated Client Portal: [Notion Link] (all timelines, deliverables & recordings live here)."

"2. Upload your brand kit & technical credentials securely via our 1Password/Intake Vault: [Link]."

"3. Confirm your Single Point of Contact (SPOC) who will approve milestone sign-offs."

Mandatory Pre-Kickoff Asset & Credential Collection Checklist

- [ ] **Brand & Design Assets:** Vector logos (.SVG/.EPS), typography files, hex color palette, and high-res photography.
- [ ] **Technical & Hosting Access:** DNS/Cloudflare admin, CMS/GitHub repo access, Google Analytics 4, and CRM API keys.
- [ ] **Historical Data & Benchmarks:** Past 12 months conversion metrics, top-performing campaigns, and customer avatars.
- [ ] **Compliance & Legal Guidelines:** Industry disclaimers, privacy policy requirements, and banned competitor claims.

SOP-11 • WORKSPACE SETUP

Internal Workspace Provisioning & Notion Client Portal Blueprint

Standardize folder nomenclature, permission tiers, and client-facing dashboards

Never let clients hunt through email threads for links. Every client receives an identical, branded Notion (or ClickUp) Portal containing five core modules.

Portal Module	Contents & Widgets Included	Permission Level	Update Cadence
01. Command Center	Live milestone progress bar, SPOC directory, SLA rules	Client View Only	Real-time
02. Deliverables Tracker	Kanban/Table of SOW items, Loom links, approval buttons	Client Comment/ Approve	Daily
03. Asset & Vault Hub	Brand guidelines, uploaded files, staging environment links	Client Edit/Upload	During Onboarding
04. Weekly Pulse Logs	Every Friday status digest, KPI snapshots, next week goals	Client View Only	Fridays 3 PM
05. Commercial & Legal	Signed MSA, SOW, paid invoices, approved Change Orders	Executive SPOC Only	Per Milestone

Internal Agency Folder Naming & Security SOP

- [ ] **Standard Folder Nomenclature:** Use [YYMM]-[ClientCode]-[ProjectCode] (e.g., 2610-ACME-WEB01) across Drive, Figma, and Git.
- [ ] **Zero Plaintext Passwords:** Never accept passwords via Slack or email; enforce 1Password shared vaults or Bitwarden Send.
- [ ] **Internal vs. External Separation:** Keep raw working files in internal folders; only link polished staging links in the Client Portal.

SOP-12 • KICKOFF EXECUTION

The 45-Minute Client Kickoff Call Agenda & Script

Lock in communication boundaries, milestone sign-off rules, and Sprint 1 deliverables

The Kickoff Call is not a brainstorming session—it is a governance alignment meeting. Use this exact run-of-show to train the client on how to be a dream client.

Minute Mark	Kickoff Agenda Segment	Lead Speaker	Output / Artifact Confirmed
00:00 – 05:00	Executive Welcome & North-Star KPI Recap	Account Lead	Confirmed 90-Day Success Metric
05:00 – 15:00	Client Portal Tour & Asset Verification	Project Manager	All missing credentials flagged
15:00 – 25:00	Communication Rules & Revision SLA Alignment	Account Lead	SPOC verbally agrees to 72h SLA
25:00 – 40:00	Phase 1 Deep-Dive & Immediate Sprint Tasks	Technical Lead	First deliverable date locked
40:00 – 45:00	Q&A and Weekly Cadence Confirmation	Project Manager	Kickoff Recap sent within 2 hours

Kickoff Call Boundary-Setting Script (Read Verbatim at Minute 15)

"Before we dive into Phase 1 execution, let's align on our working cadence so we hit your [Launch Date] deadline without a hitch:"

"1. Communication Hours: We operate asynchronously inside your Portal and Slack between 9 AM and 5 PM EST, Mon–Fri. Emergency weekend requests carry a rush fee, so we plan ahead."

"2. Consolidated Feedback: When we deliver a milestone via Loom, [SPOC Name] will gather internal team notes into one unified comment doc within 72 hours."

"3. Protecting Your Timeline: If a new idea pops up mid-sprint, we'll log it in the Phase 2 Backlog or quote a quick Change Order so we never derail your launch date."

SOP-13 • CLIENT CADENCE

Asynchronous Communication Charter & Friday Status Digest

Prevent "just checking in" emails by proactively sending structured Friday updates

Clients only send anxious "Hey, what's the status?" messages when they feel in the dark. Beat them to the punch every Friday before 3:00 PM with the 5-Bullet Friday Pulse Report.

The "Friday 3 PM Pulse Report" Template (Slack / Email / Portal)

"Subject: [Company] Weekly Pulse — Sprint [X] Status: [ON TRACK Ø=ßâ]"

"Hi [First Name], here is your 60-second executive summary for the week ending [Date]:"

"' COMPLETED THIS WEEK: (1) [Deliverable A — Link + 2-min Loom], (2) [Deliverable B — Approved]."

"Ø=Ý(IN PROGRESS FOR NEXT WEEK: (1) [Task C — Target Delivery Wednesday], (2) [Task D]."

"Ø=Þ¨ ACTION REQUIRED FROM YOU: Please approve [Deliverable A] in the Portal by Tuesday 5 PM so Sprint 2 stays on schedule."

"Have a restful weekend! — [Your Name]"

The 3-Minute Loom Presentation Standard (Replace Meetings With Video)

- [ ] **0:00–0:30 Context & Goal:** Remind the client which business KPI this specific deliverable solves.
- [ ] **0:30–2:15 Strategic Walkthrough:** Show the work and explain WHY decisions were made (anchor to conversion/data).
- [ ] **2:15–3:00 Explicit Feedback Prompt:** Tell them what to critique ("Please check factual accuracy in Section 2") and what is already locked.

SOP-14 • QUALITY ASSURANCE

Pre-Delivery QA Gate & Milestone Sign-Off Protocol

Zero-defect internal inspection checklist before any link reaches the client

Never allow a junior specialist to send unreviewed work directly to a client. Every deliverable must pass the Internal 10-Point QA Gate and ship with a formal Milestone Sign-Off form.

Formal Milestone Sign-Off & Invoice Trigger Template

"Subject: [Milestone #X Ready for Sign-Off] — [Deliverable Name]"

"Hi [First Name], excited to share the completed [Milestone Name]! Watch my 3-minute walkthrough here: [Loom Link] and inspect the live build here: [Link]."

"Per our SOW, please reply 'APPROVED' or submit your consolidated revision notes inside the Portal by [Date + 3 Business Days]. Upon sign-off, Milestone Invoice #[X] will be issued and we will immediately unlock Phase [X+1]."

Internal Pre-Flight QA Checklist (Required Before Sending to Client)

- [ ] **SOW Compliance Check:** Every specification listed in Schedule A for this milestone is 100% present.
- [ ] **Brand & Copy Audit:** Zero typos, broken links, placeholder "Lorem Ipsum", or wrong hex colors.
- [ ] **Mobile & Cross-Device Check:** Tested on 1440px desktop, 768px tablet, and 390px mobile viewports.
- [ ] **Loom Walkthrough Recorded:** Accompanied by a 3-minute strategic Loom explaining rationale and approval steps.

SOP-15 • REVENUE EXPANSION

Standardized Change Order (CO) Template & Pricing Formula

Monetize scope additions cleanly with a 1-page mini-contract

A well-run agency generates 18%–25% additional contract revenue purely from structured Change Orders. Keep this 1-page template ready in PandaDoc/DocuSign.

Change Order Field	Standardized Specification / Entry
Change Order Reference	CO-[YYYY]-[00X] attached to Master Services Agreement dated [Date]
Requested Addition	Detailed description of new feature, page, workflow, or integration
Excluded / Unchanged	All other terms and exclusions of original SOW remain in full effect
Timeline Impact	Adds [X] business days to Phase [Y] and shifts Final Launch Date to [New Date]
Change Order Fee	$[X,XXX] flat fee (100% due upon Change Order signature before work begins)
Expiration Window	Valid for 5 business days; requires digital signature of Client SPOC

CHANGE ORDER PRICING FORMULA

CO Price = (Estimated Specialist Hours × Internal Cost × 3.2 Margin Multiplier) + 15% Project Management Overhead. Minimum Change Order floor: $750.

SOP-16 • CRISIS MANAGEMENT

Client Escalation Matrix & Boundary Recovery Scripts

Word-for-word scripts to handle missed client deadlines, scope pushback, and late payments

Friction Level	Trigger Event	Owner	Mandatory Action Within 24h
Level 1: Yellow	Client misses feedback SLA by 48h	Project Mgr	Send Timeline Shift Notice email
Level 2: Orange	Client disputes out-of-scope CO	Account Lead	15-min diagnostic call + SOW review
Level 3: Red	Invoice >7 days overdue or abusive tone	Agency Founder	Immediate work freeze + formal notice

3 High-Stakes De-Escalation Scripts

SCENARIO A — CLIENT GHOSTS FOR 7+ DAYS: "Hi [Name], we haven’t heard back on [Milestone] since [Date]. To protect your team’s launch quality, we are pausing active sprint capacity today at 5 PM. Whenever you’re ready to resume, let us know and we’ll re-slot your timeline."

SCENARIO B — CLIENT SENDS PIECEMEAL SLACK EDITS: "Hi [Name], caught your 4 Slack notes! To make sure zero details slip through the cracks, I’ve pasted them into your Consolidated Revision Doc [Link]. Let me know once your team finishes adding final notes and we will execute the full batch at once."

SCENARIO C — INVOICE OVERDUE BY 5 DAYS: "Hi [Name], friendly heads up that Invoice #[X] is 5 days past due. Per our automated billing system, staging environments and active sprints pause at Day 7. Here is the direct payment link [Link] so we don’t lose a single day of momentum."

SOP-17 • CLEAN OFFBOARDING

Executive Offboarding Checklist & Final Handover Packet

Leave a 5-star final impression while cleanly terminating free post-launch support

How you end a project determines whether the client refers three peers or drains your team with six months of unpaid "quick questions." Deliver a formal Executive Handover Packet.

12-Point Project Offboarding & Asset Transfer Checklist

- [ ] **Final Invoice Cleared:** Verify 100% of principal milestones and Change Orders are paid in full before transferring ownership.
- [ ] **Master Handover Manual:** Compile final URLs, Figma source files, GitHub repos, and CMS admin links in one PDF.
- [ ] **Custom SOP Loom Library:** Record 3–5 short Loom videos showing the client's team how to edit text, images, and settings.
- [ ] **Credential & API Rotation:** Transfer billing ownership of domains/plugins to Client card and revoke temporary agency tokens.
- [ ] **Warranty Window Notice:** State clearly when the 14-day bug-fix window expires and how ongoing support is billed.

POST-LAUNCH WARRANTY BOUNDARY

Include in the Handover Email: "Your 14-day post-launch bug warranty runs through [Date]. After [Date], any edits, updates, or troubleshooting require an active Growth Retainer or $750 Maintenance Block."

SOP-18 • SOCIAL PROOF ENGINE

High-Converting Testimonial & ROI Case Study Request Templates

Capture quantifiable video and written proof at the exact moment of peak client euphoria

Never ask "Would you mind writing us a testimonial?" Clients are busy and write generic praise ("Great to work with!"). Give them a structured 4-question prompt or a pre-drafted paragraph to approve in 30 seconds.

Case Study Section	Data Point to Extract	Where to Deploy
1. The Baseline	Revenue/conversion rate before hiring us	Proposal Deck Slide 4
2. The Bottleneck	Why internal efforts failed previously	Discovery Call Objection Handler
3. The Architecture	3 specific steps our agency implemented	Website Case Study Page
4. The Quantified ROI	+X% lift, $Y added revenue, Z hours saved	LinkedIn & Cold Email Hook

The "Approve-or-Edit in 30 Seconds" Testimonial Request Email

"Subject: Quick favor + celebrating [Company]'s launch Ø=Þ€"

"Hi [First Name], it's been a privilege building [Project] with you. Seeing [Metric/Result] already moving is huge."

"We're updating our portfolio and I'd love to feature [Company]. Since I know your schedule is packed, I drafted a quick quote below based on our results—feel free to tweak a word or just reply 'Approved to use!'"

"DRAFT QUOTE: 'Before hiring [Agency], we struggled with [Problem]. Within [X] weeks, their team delivered [Solution], which helped us achieve [Specific Metric/Result]. Easily the most organized partner we've worked with.'"

"(Bonus: If you have 60 seconds to read that on a quick phone video via [Senja/VideoAsk Link], I'll send a $[100] gift card for your team's lunch!)"

SOP-19 • LTV EXPANSION

Project-to-Retainer Upsell Script & B2B Referral Engine

Convert 40%+ of one-off projects into predictable Monthly Recurring Revenue (MRR)

Acquiring a new agency client costs 6x more than retaining an existing one. Pitch your recurring Optimization Retainer during the Offboarding Call while pointing to Phase 2 growth opportunities.

The Offboarding-to-Retainer Transition Script

"Now that Phase 1 is live, the biggest mistake we see companies make is treating [Asset/System] as static while competitors iterate monthly."

"During our build, we logged 6 high-leverage Phase 2 opportunities in your Backlog—including [Item A] and [Item B]—that should add another [X%] to conversion."

"Instead of scoping a brand-new project later, most clients move onto our $[2,500]/mo Growth Partner Retainer. It gives you [X] dedicated sprint hours every month, priority 24h SLA, and continuous split-testing. Want to lock in one of our 2 retainer slots for next month?"

The 30-Day Post-Launch Referral Trigger System

- [ ] **Day 30 Check-In Audit:** Send a 2-minute Loom reviewing their first 30 days of live metrics with 2 quick optimization tips.
- [ ] **The Specific Referral Ask:** Ask: "Who is one founder in your network currently dealing with [Exact Problem You Solved]?"
- [ ] **Partner Bounty Structure:** Offer a 10% cash referral commission or $1,000 service credit for every closed intro.

SOP-20 • EXECUTIVE GOVERNANCE

Weekly Agency Operations & Margin Health Scorecard

Track utilization, effective hourly rate (EHR), and onboarding velocity like a $5M consultancy

Review these 6 operational metrics every Monday morning. If any metric dips into the Red Zone for two consecutive weeks, trigger the corresponding corrective SOP immediately.

Agency KPI Metric	Formula / Calculation	Healthy Target	Red Zone Trigger -> Corrective SOP
Effective Hourly Rate	Project Fee ÷ Total Team Hours	> $175 / hr	< $110/hr -> Audit unbilled scope creep (SOP-08)
Proposal Win Rate	Signed Contracts ÷ Proposals Sent	35% – 50%	< 25% -> Tighten Pre-Call Triage (SOP-02)
Onboarding Velocity	Contract Signed to Kickoff Complete	< 72 Hours	> 5 Days -> Automate Portal Setup (SOP-09)
Change Order Yield	CO Revenue ÷ Base Contract Value	15% – 25%	< 5% -> Train PMs on CO Script (SOP-15)
Retainer Conversion	Clients Moving to MRR ÷ Completed	> 35%	< 20% -> Pitch Retainer at Day 21 (SOP-19)
Client NPS / Proof	Approved Case Studies ÷ Projects	> 80%	< 50% -> Send Pre-Drafted Quote (SOP-18)

90-DAY IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

Week 1: Install Intake Form & Discovery Script. Week 2: Deploy 3-Tier Proposal & SOW Clauses. Week 3: Build Notion Portal & 72-Hour Automation. Week 4: Enforce Friday Pulse & Change Order Rules.